

ask? It's simple. The zest to work hard arises from a simple fact - if you won't, who will?

As a freelancer, the responsibilities are manifold. You need to deal with everything under the sun - right from creating schedules to garnering new jobs, getting the paperwork and accounts in order, etc. The only way to pay the bills as a freelancer is to focus on getting new work and retaining work from older clients. As most jobs you take up might be contractual or short term work, it's imperative that one of the life skills you acquire is that of learning how to advertise yourself as a freelancer.

### **I'm good, hire me**

Sounds cheesy, doesn't it? No one likes tooting their own horn. Truth be said, advertising isn't about blowing your own trumpet. It's about getting the word out there about a service you provide. There are clients out there who need the services you provide as a freelancer, but they don't know where to look. Advertising effectively would mean connecting them to you, and that's what you need to focus on doing to bring in new work and keep the ball rolling.

### **Word of mouth**

The oldest trick in the book of freelance advertising and it has never failed and probably never will. A job well done and a happy client at the end of the day are most likely to recommend your name to a friend/acquaintance/colleague who need services. The beauty of word of mouth advertising is that the person receiving the message gets it from someone they already trust. That's half the battle won.

Try to get active on social media platforms. Talk about the work you are doing and the services you provide. You will be surprised at the number of people who need services similar to yours, but didn't know you were providing them. Get friends and family to talk about your Facebook page or Instagram feed or Pinterest handle (or all of these mediums), depending on where your presence is the most effective.

### **Getting the information out**

Setting up a professional looking website might not be your cup of tea given the costs it involves initially. A blog is a simpler way of getting the word out. It surely doesn't hurt that blogs can be created for no money at all. They allow for you to write about topics related to your industry as well as cite